Ans. (b): In the national parks of India, local people are not allowed to accure and use livestock in reserved areas. The National Wildlife Action plan was launched in 1983. Harvesting, grazing and habitat damages are not allowed in the park areas, while the sanctuary has some leeway.

88. The Millennium Ecosystem Assessment describes the following major categories of ecosystem services-provisioning, supporting, regulating, preserving and cultural. Which one of the following is supporting service ?
(a) Production of food and water
(b) Control of climate and disease
(c) Nutrient cycling and crop pollination
(d) Maintenance of diversity

Ans. (c) : According to the 'Millennium Ecosystem Assessment, Nutrient cycling and pollination is in the category of supporting services. These services are essential for all other services and the basic sustenance of the ecosystem. The Millennium Ecosystem Assessment (MEA) was called for by the United Nations Secretary-General Kofi Annan in 2000. Initiated in 2001, the objective of the MA was to assess the consequences of ecosystem change for human well-being and the scientific basis for action needed to enhance the conservation and sustainable use of those systems and their contribution to human well-being.

89. Which of the following can be threats to the biodiversity of a geographical area ?
1. Global warming
2. Fragmentation of habitat
3. Invasion of alien species
4. Promotion of vegetarianism

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (a): Global warming, fragmentation of habitat and Invasion of alien species can be threats to the biodiversity of a geographical area.

90. Consider the following agricultural practices :
1. Contour bunding
2. Relay cropping
3. Zero tillage

In the context of global climate change, which of the above helps/help in carbon sequestration/ storage in the soil?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) None of them

Ans. (b): In the context of global climate change, contour bunding, relay cropping and zero tillage all three methods are helpful in the storage of carbon in the soil. But the Union Public Service Commission has considered the answer to this question as an option (b).

Current Affairs

91. Consider the following protected areas:
1. Bandipur 2. Bhitarkanika
3. Manas 4. Sunderbans

Which of the above are declared Tiger Reserves?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (b) : Bhitarkanika (Odisha) is reserved for crocodile while Bandipur (Karnataka), Manas (Assam) and Sundarbans (West Bengal) are tiger reserves. The 'Project Tiger' was launched in India on 1st April 1973. A total of 42 tiger reserves have been created in the country so far (when the questions was asked). Currently, 52 tiger reserves are in India (June 2021).

92. The National Green Tribunal Act, 2010 was enacted in consonance with which of the following provisions of the Constitution of India ?
1. Right to healthy environment, construed as a part of Right to life under Article 21.
2. Provision of grants for raising the level of administration in the Scheduled Areas for the welfare of Scheduled Tribes under Article 275 (1).
3. Powers and functions of Gram Sabha as mentioned under Article 243 (A.)

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
(a) 1only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and

Ans. (a) : The National Green Tribunal Act, 2010 embraces the objective that the right to a healthy environment has been construed as a part of the right to life under Article 21 of the constitution in the judicial pronouncement in India.

93. If National Water Mission is properly and completely implemented, how will it impact the country ?
1. Part of the water needs of urban areas will be met through recycling of wastewater.
2. The water requirements of coastal cities with inadequate alternative sources of water will be met by adopting appropriate technologies that allow for the use of ocean water.
3. All the rivers of Himalayan origin will be linked to the rivers of peninsular India.
4. The expenses incurred by farmers for digging, bore-wells and for installing motors and pump-sets to draw groundwater will be completely reimbursed by the Government.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (b): If National Water Mission is properly and completely implemented, then the part of the water needs of urban areas will be met through recycling of waste water. The water requirements of coastal cities with inadequate alternative sources of water will be met by adopting appropriate technologies that allow for the use of ocean water.

94. With reference to consumers rights/privileges under the provisions of law in India, which of the following statements is/are correct ?
1. Consumers are empowered to take samples for food testing.
2. When a consumer files a complaint in any consumer forum, no fee is required to be paid.
3. In case of death of a consumer, his /her legal heir can file a complaint in the consumer forum in his/her behalf.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c) : The Consumer Protection Act, 1986 was passed by the Government of India in the year 1986 for the protection of the interests of consumers. Under its provisions, consumers have the right to take samples for testing the food. If a disturbance is found, the Consumer can file his complaint in the consumer Forum. If the litigant consumer dies during the litigation, then his legal heir can file his complaint in the consumer forum on his/her behalf.

• Indian Heritage and Culture

95. With reference to Dhrupad, one of the major traditions of India that has been kept alive for centuries, which of the following statements are correct ?
1. Dhrupad originated and developed in the Rajput kingdoms during the Mughal period.
2. Dhrupad is primarily a devotional and spiritual music.
3. Dhrupad Alap uses Sanskrit syllables from Mantras.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3
(d) None of the above is correct

Ans. (c) : Dhrupad is the oldest surviving form of Indian classical music and traces its origin to the chanting of Vedic hymns and mantras during the Vedic age. Most Dhrupads are religious in nature praising Hindu Gods (originally sung in temples), although some texts praise the kings. A Dhrupad performance starts with the alap, which uses sacred Sanskrit syllables from Sanskrit Mantras.

96. How do you distinguish between Kuchipudi and Bharatanatyam dances ?
1. Dancers occasionally speaking dialogues is found in Kuchipudi dance but not in Bharatanatyam.
2. Dancing on the brass plate by keeping the feet on its edges is a feature of Bharatanatyam but Kuchipudi dance does not have such a form of movements.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a) : 'Bharatanatyam' is primarily a dance form of Tamil Nadu and has now taken PAN India form. Kuchipudi has its roots in Andhra Pradesh. Tambulam (brass plate) is not used in Bharatanatyam, whereas in Kuchipudi dance, the dancers use Tambulam in popular form.

• Environment and Ecology

97. Which one of the following groups of animals belongs to the category of endangered species?
(a) Great Indian Bustard , Musk Deer, Red Panda and Asiatic Wild Ass.
(b) Kashmir Stage, Cheetal, Blue Bull and Great Indian Bustard.
(c) Snow Leopard, Swamp Deer, Rhesus Monkey and Saras (Crane).
(d) Lion-tailed Macaque, Blue Bull, Hanuman Langur and Cheetal.

Ans. (a): The Great Indian Bustard, Musk Dear, Red Panda and Asiatic Wild Ass come under the category of endangered species. Some such species of fauna have not disappeared completely but are on the verge of extinction. Such as African elephant, vulture, porcupine, black beer, reindeer, etc., are prominent.

98. Vultures which used to be very common in Indian countryside some years ago are rarely seen nowadays. This is attributed to-
(a) the destruction of their nesting sites by new invasive species.
(b) a drug used by cattle owners for treating their diseased cattle.
(c) scarcity of food available to them.
(d) a widespread, persistent and fatal disease among them.

Ans. (b) : Until a few years ago, vultures used to appear in the Indian countryside but are rarely seen nowadays. The main reason for this is the drug (diclofenac) used by cattle owners for the treatment of sick animals. About 100 million vultures have been killed in India and Pakistan in the last decade as a result of the use of diclofenac medicine.

99. Consider the following
1. Black-necked crane 2. Cheetah
3. Flying squirrel 4. Snow leopard

Which of the above are naturally found in India?
(a) 1, 2 and 3 only (b) 1, 3 and 4 only
(c) 2 and 4 only (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (b): Black-necked cranes, flying squirrels and snow leopards are found naturally in India. There are about 1500000 fauna species in the world, of which there are 250000 flora species. Among all the world's animal species 91212 amphibian and insect species are found only in North India. The Cheetah is the only animal that is currently on the verge of extinction.

100. Government of India encourages the cultivation of 'sea buckthorn'. What is the importance of this plant ?
1. It helps in controlling soil erosion and in preventing desertification.
2. It is a rich source of biodiesel.
3. It has nutritional value and is well-adapted to live in cold areas of high altitudes.
4. Its timber is of great commercial value.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct ?
(a) 1 only (b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans. (c) : The Indian government is encouraging 'Sea buckthorn' farming. The farming of this plant is helpful in controlling soil erosion and prevents desertification and has nutritional value and is well adapted to survive in high altitude cold areas.